BOGNER'S STRANGE CALABI-YAU OPERATOR CARRIES A $\sqrt{2}$ TWIST

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Abstract. Bogner found a fourth order operator of Calabi-Yau type whose holomorphic period, mirror map and Yukawa coupling are integral while its instanton numbers are not: n_p has denominator p^2 at every prime $p \geq 3$ that has been examined. We show that the operator is the Hadamard product of $\sum \binom{2n}{n} x^n$ with the symmetric square of a modular second order operator for an index four subgroup of $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$, and that the instanton numbers become integers, for all $d \leq 110$, when they are read through a Galois twisted multicover formula over $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$. The twist is dictated by the cusp, where the Hauptmodul satisfies $x^4 \approx -q_\tau/4$. A twisted form of a theorem of Beukers and Vlasenko proves the twisted integrality at each prime $p \geq 5$ from a p-adic Frobenius structure with a specified first constant. We state the existence of that structure as a hypothesis, and certify its truncations at $p = 5, 7, 11, 13, 17$, up to degree 1000 at $p = 5$; every truncation forces the predicted constant. We also show that rescaling the coordinate does not help (for algebraic irrational scalings conditional on an all-prime congruence, for rational ones of bounded height), that the strong structure does not exist at $p = 3$, and that two natural routes to the hypothesis are closed.

1. Introduction

Let $\theta = x\frac{d}{dx}$ and

$$P = \theta^4 - 8x(2\theta+1)^2(5\theta^2+5\theta+2) + 192x^2(2\theta+1)(3\theta+2)(3\theta+4)(2\theta+3).$$

This operator appears in Bogner's thesis [5] and is discussed by van Straten [7, pp. 28–29] and by Almkvist and van Straten [2, p. 21]. It has the holomorphic solution $y_0 = 1 + 16x + 576x^2 + 25600x^3 + \cdots$, the integral mirror map $q = x + 40x^2 + 1984x^3 + \cdots$ and the integral Yukawa coupling

$$K(q) = 1 + 8q - 5632q^3 - 456064q^4 - 17708032q^5 + \cdots .$$

(The printed $8q^2$ in [2] is a misprint for $8q$.) Writing $K(q) = 1 + \sum_{d\geq 1} n_d d^3 q^d/(1-q^d)$ gives $n_1 = 8$, $n_2 = -1$, $n_3 = -1880/9$, $n_5 = -3541608/25$, and n_p has denominator p^2 for the odd primes tested. Van Straten calls this "rather puzzling": integrality of the period and the mirror map suggests a rank four Calabi-Yau motive, to which the general integrality arguments should apply. He adds that there may be a different scaling of the coordinate that repairs the defect.

Table 1 shows what this note proposes instead. The left column is the usual expansion. The right column reads the same coupling through a multicover formula twisted by $\sqrt{2}$ (Section 4), and every entry becomes an integer.

The results are as follows.

(1) (Structure, Section 2.) $P = I \star \mathrm{Sym}^2 D$, where I is the first order operator of $\sum \binom{2n}{n} x^n$, $\star$ is the Hadamard product, and D is a second order operator whose holomorphic solution is $(1-16x)^{-1/4}\,{}_2F_1\big(\frac{1}{12}, \frac{5}{12}; 1; -6912x^4/(1-16x)^3\big)$. Equivalently $j = (16x-1)^3/(4x^4)$.

(2) (Scaling obstructions, Section 3.) Conditional on $K_p \equiv 8 \pmod p$ for almost all primes, no algebraic irrational rescaling makes the instanton numbers integral at almost all primes. No rational scaling with numerator and denominator at most 3000 works.

d	untwisted n_d	twisted n_d
1	8	8
2	-1	0
3	$-1880/9$	-208
4	-7126	-7126
5	$-3541608/25$	-141664
6	$-18136853/9$	-2015232

Table 1. Instanton numbers of Bogner's operator, untwisted and twisted.

(3) (Twisted integrality, Section 4.) With the multicover weights $w_d(k) = \left(\frac{2}{k}\right)^d 2^{d(k-1)/2}$ for odd k (Section 4 treats even k) the numbers defined by $K_m = \sum_{d|m} n_d\, d^3\, w_d(m/d)$ are integers for all $d \le 110$.

(4) (Explanation, Section 5.) The weights come from the Frobenius lift $q \mapsto c_p q^p$ with $c_p = \left(\frac{2}{p}\right) 2^{(p-1)/2}$, which is the lift the cusp of D dictates. A twisted form of a theorem of Beukers and Vlasenko [3] turns a Frobenius structure with first constant $\log_p(c_p)/p$ into twisted integrality at $p \ge 5$. Finite truncations of such a structure exist at $p = 5, 7, 11, 13, 17$ and force that constant.

(5) (Approaches, Section 6.) Models of the period, and proofs or computations that close two routes to the remaining hypothesis.

All computations use exact rational arithmetic. The scripts that produce each number are listed in Section 8.

2. Structure of the operator

Proposition 2.1. *Let*

$$D = \theta^2 - 4x(10\theta^2 + 5\theta + 1) + 48x^2(3\theta + 1)(3\theta + 2),$$
$$L = \theta^3 - 4x(2\theta + 1)(5\theta^2 + 5\theta + 2) + 48x^2(\theta + 1)(3\theta + 2)(3\theta + 4).$$

Then $L = \mathrm{Sym}^2 D$ and $P = I \star L$. In particular the holomorphic solution of P is $y_0 = \sum_n \binom{2n}{n} u_n x^n$ where $\sum_n u_n x^n = f^2$ and f is the holomorphic solution of D.

Proof. The symmetric square of a second order operator is computed by the recursion in [5, Lemma 4.2.4]; comparing normalised coefficients with those of L gives equality as rational functions (checked symbolically). If $(n+1)^3 u_{n+1} = R_1(n)u_n - R_2(n)u_{n-1}$ with $R_1 = 4(2n+1)(5n^2+5n+2)$ and $R_2 = 48n(9n^2-1)$, then $v_n = \binom{2n}{n} u_n$ satisfies $(n+1)^4 v_{n+1} = 2(2n+1)R_1(n)v_n - 4(4n^2-1)(R_2(n)/n)v_{n-1}$, which is the recurrence of P. □

The operator D has singular points 0, the complex conjugate pair $x_\pm = (5 \pm i\sqrt{2})/108$ and ∞, with local exponents $\{0,0\}$, $\{0, \frac{1}{2}\}$ and $\{\frac{1}{3}, \frac{2}{3}\}$. This is the signature of a genus zero group with one cusp, two elliptic points of order two and one of order three.

Proposition 2.2. *The holomorphic solution of D is*

$$f(x) = (1-16x)^{-1/4}\, {}_2F_1\left(\tfrac{1}{12}, \tfrac{5}{12}; 1; \frac{-6912x^4}{(1-16x)^3}\right).$$

Equivalently, f is the pullback of $E_4^{1/4} = {}_2F_1(\frac{1}{12}, \frac{5}{12}; 1; 1728/j)$ along

$$j = \frac{(16x-1)^3}{4x^4}, \qquad j - 1728 = -\frac{(1-4x)^2(432x^2 - 40x + 1)}{4x^4},$$

a degree four map ramified as (4) *over* ∞*,* $(3,1)$ *over* 0 *and* $(2,1,1)$ *over* 1728*. Hence* x *is a Hauptmodul for an index four subgroup of* $\mathrm{PSL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ *with one cusp, of width four.*

Proof. Write $g = (1-16x)^{-1/4}F(z(x))$ with $z(x) = -6912x^4/(1-16x)^3$ and F any solution of the Gauss equation with parameters $(\frac{1}{12}, \frac{5}{12}; 1)$. Eliminating F'' with the Gauss equation, $D(g)$ simplifies to zero (checked symbolically). Since D has exponents $0, 0$ at the origin, the holomorphic solution with value 1 is unique. The factorisation of $j - 1728$ is direct, and a branched cover of the j-line with ramification indices dividing $\infty, 3, 2$ over $\infty, 0, 1728$ corresponds to a finite index subgroup. □

Near the cusp, $1/j = -4x^4 + O(x^5)$, so the Tate parameter satisfies

$$q_\tau = -4x^4\big(1 + O(x)\big). \tag{1}$$

The Frobenius compatible coordinate at the cusp is therefore $(-4)^{1/4}x = (1+i)x$ up to a fourth root of unity. This constant drives everything in Sections 4 and 5. Figure 1 shows the cover and where the constant comes from.

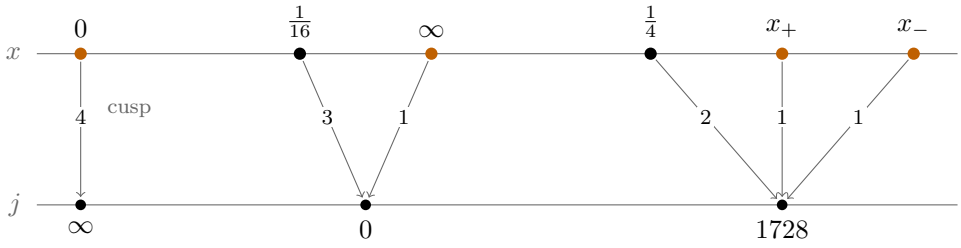


Figure 1. The degree four map $j = (16x-1)^3/(4x^4)$ from the x-line to the j-line, with the ramification of Proposition 2.2. The cusp $x = 0$ lies over $j = \infty$ with index 4, and there $1/j = -4x^4 + O(x^5)$: a fourth root of -4, hence $\sqrt{2}$, enters the coordinate compatible with $q_\tau \mapsto q_\tau^p$. Singular points of D are in copper.

Remark 2.3. D is, up to the algebraic gauge factor $(432x^2 - 40x + 1)^{1/4}$, the Picard-Fuchs operator of the rational elliptic surface

$$Y^2 = 4X^3 - 3(1-16x)(432x^2 - 40x + 1)\,X - (1-4x)(432x^2 - 40x + 1)^2,$$

whose j-invariant is $(16x-1)^3/(4x^4)$ and whose discriminant is $-186624\,x^4(432x^2 - 40x + 1)^3$. Its singular fibres are I_4 at 0, III at $x_\pm$ and II at ∞.

Corollary 2.4. *Via Clausen's formula,*

$$u_n = \sum_{m=0}^{\lfloor n/4 \rfloor} (-1)^m\, 4^{\,n-3m}\, \frac{(2n-2m)!}{m!^3\,(n-m)!\,(n-4m)!},$$

and $y_0 = \sum \binom{2n}{n} u_n x^n$*. In particular* u_n *and* y_0 *have integer coefficients: the factorial ratio is a multinomial coefficient and* $n - 3m \geq 0$ *throughout the sum. The sequence* $u_n = 1, 8, 96, 1280, 17440, \ldots$ *is not in the OEIS (searched 27 September 2026). The formula agrees with the recurrence of* L *for* $n \leq 120$*.*

Proposition 2.5. *Let $h(Y) = Y + 2 + Y^{-1}$. Then, as formal power series in t,*

$$\sum_n u_n t^n = \mathrm{CT}_{a,b,Y} \frac{1}{1 - 4t\,h(Y)(1+a+b) + \frac{t^2}{4}\,h(Y)/(ab)},$$
$$y_0 = \mathrm{CT}_{a,b,Y,Z} \frac{1}{1 - 4t\,h(Y)h(Z)(1+a+b) + \frac{t^2}{4}\,h(Y)h(Z)^2/(ab)}.$$

Proof. Expand $[t^n](1 - tA + t^2B)^{-1} = \sum_k (-1)^k \binom{n-k}{k} A^{n-2k} B^k$. With $A = 4h(Y)(1+a+b)$ and $B = h(Y)/(4ab)$, the constant term in a, b of $(1+a+b)^{n-2k}(ab)^{-k}$ is $(n-2k)!/(k!^2(n-4k)!)$ and $\mathrm{CT}_Y\, h(Y)^{n-k} = \binom{2n-2k}{n-k}$. Collecting factors gives the closed form of the corollary. The second identity follows from $\mathrm{CT}_Z\, h(Z)^n = \binom{2n}{n}$. □

Corollary 2.6. *There is also a three-variable double-cover period representation*

$$y_0(t) = \mathrm{CT}_{a,b,Z} \left(1 - 16t\,h(Z)(1+a+b) + \frac{t^2 h(Z)^2}{ab}\right)^{-1/2}.$$

Proof. For a formal series C of positive t-adic order, $\mathrm{CT}_Y(1 - Ch(Y))^{-1} = \sum_{r\geq 0} \binom{2r}{r} C^r = (1-4C)^{-1/2}$. Use $C = 4th(Z)(1+a+b) - t^2h(Z)^2/(4ab)$ in Proposition 2.5. □

3. Obstructions to rescaling

The Yukawa coupling is an invariant of P up to $q \mapsto cq$ [7]. Rescaling replaces K_m by $c^m K_m$.

Proposition 3.1. *Let c be a nonzero algebraic number. Assume $K_p \equiv 8 \pmod p$ for all but finitely many primes p (it holds for every odd $p \leq 109$, and would follow from (2) at all odd primes). If the instanton numbers of $K(cq)$ are integral at all but finitely many primes, then $c \in \mathbb{Q}$.*

Proof. Let F be the Galois closure of $\mathbb{Q}(c)$. For a prime $\mathfrak{p}$ of F above p, unramified, with c a $\mathfrak{p}$-unit and $p \nmid 2$, integrality of $n_p(c) = (c^p K_p - 8c)/p^3$ gives $c^p K_p \equiv 8c \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. Since $K_p \equiv 8 \pmod p$, this gives $c^p \equiv c \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$, that is $\mathrm{Frob}_{\mathfrak{p}}(c) \equiv c \pmod{\mathfrak{p}}$. For each $\sigma \in \mathrm{Gal}(F/\mathbb{Q})$ with $\sigma(c) \neq c$ the nonzero number $\sigma(c) - c$ is divisible by only finitely many primes, while by Chebotarev $\sigma = \mathrm{Frob}_{\mathfrak{p}}$ for infinitely many $\mathfrak{p}$. Hence $\sigma(c) = c$ for all σ. □

Proposition 3.2. *For every $c = \pm a/b$ with $1 \leq a, b \leq 3000$ there is a prime $p \leq 79$, $p \nmid ab$, with $c^{p-1} K_p \not\equiv 8 \pmod{p^2}$. In particular some instanton number of $K(cq)$ fails to be p-integral.*

This is a finite computation over Fermat quotients. The same search, run on data planted with $c = 17/5$, returns exactly that value.

4. The twisted multicover formula

For $d, k \geq 1$ put

$$w_d(k) = \begin{cases} \left(\frac{2}{k}\right)^d\, 2^{d(k-1)/2} & k \text{ odd}, \\ 2^{d(k-1)/2} & k \text{ even},\ d \text{ even}, \\ 0 & k \text{ even},\ d \text{ odd}, \end{cases}$$

with the Jacobi symbol $\left(\frac{2}{k}\right)$, and define n_d recursively by $K_m = \sum_{d \mid m} n_d\, d^3\, w_d(m/d)$. In words, the coefficient K_m collects, for each $d \mid m$, the degree d number n_d counted $k = m/d$ times over; the classical formula gives each k-fold cover weight 1, and the twisted one gives it weight $w_d(k)$.

Remark 4.1. With $Q = \sqrt{2}\,q$ and $\nu_d = n_d\,2^{-d/2}$ this reads

$$K(Q/\sqrt{2}) = 1 + \sum_d d^3 \sum_k \mathrm{Frob}_k(\nu_d)\,Q^{dk},$$

where, for odd k, Frob_k acts on $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$ by $\sqrt{2} \mapsto \left(\frac{2}{k}\right)\sqrt{2}$. For even k the displayed symbol denotes instead the projection $\nu \mapsto (\nu + \bar{\nu})/2$ to $\mathbb{Q}$. This even-multiplier convention is part of our definition, not a Frobenius automorphism at the ramified prime 2. The formula is Galois equivariant for odd multipliers.

Observation 4.2. The numbers n_d are integers for all $d \le 110$. The first are

$$8,\ 0,\ -208,\ -7126,\ -141664,\ -2015232,\ -3250624,\ 1056216756,\ 46257581056,\ \ldots$$

With the untwisted weights $w \equiv 1$, 76 of the first 80 are not integers.

The weights are rigid. Replacing $\sqrt{2}$ by $\sqrt{3}$, dropping the sign, using $\left(\frac{-1}{k}\right)$, or using $\left(\frac{2}{k}\right)$ in place of $\left(\frac{2}{k}\right)^d$ each produces non-integral values within $d \le 80$, and so does altering K_{45} by 45^2.

At a single odd prime the formula is equivalent to a twisted Dwork congruence. Put

$$c_p = \left(\frac{2}{p}\right) 2^{(p-1)/2} \equiv 1 \pmod{p}.$$

Observation 4.3. For every odd prime p and every $n \le 110$ divisible by p,

$$K_n \equiv c_p^{n/p}\,K_{n/p} \pmod{p^{3v_p(n)}}. \tag{2}$$

There are 135 such pairs (p, n), including $p = 3, n = 81$ modulo 3^{12}, and all hold. With $c_p = 1$ only 16 hold. With $c_p = 2^{(p-1)/2}$ (no sign), 82 hold.

For comparison, Table 2 lists Hadamard products $I \star L'$ for classical third order operators L', each the symmetric square of a modular operator with a cusp of width one. Their untwisted instanton numbers fail to be integral only at a few primes, as expected from N-integrality. The operator P fails at every prime, which is a different phenomenon.

L'	primes in denominators of n_d, $d \le 20$
Apéry $\zeta(3)$	$2, 3$
Domb	3
Almkvist-Zudilin	none
Cooper s_7	$2, 7$
Cooper s_{10}	5
L (this paper)	every prime $p \le 19$

Table 2. Untwisted instanton numbers of $I \star L'$.

5. Frobenius structures

We use the framework of Beukers and Vlasenko [3]. Let p be an odd prime and σ a Frobenius lift on $\mathbb{Z}_p[[x]]$. A p-adic Frobenius structure for P is an operator $A = \sum_{i=0}^{3} A_i(x)\theta^i$ with $A_i \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[x]]$ and $A_0(0) = 1$ such that $A(y(x^\sigma))$ is a solution whenever y is [3, Def. 1.1]. For the lift $x^\sigma = x^p$ the Frobenius basis $y_0, \ldots, y_3$ satisfies $A(y_i^\sigma) = p^i \sum_{j \le i} \alpha_j y_{i-j}$ [3, Remark 1.2]. Beukers and Vlasenko prove that if P is self dual and $\alpha_1 = 0$, then the untwisted instanton numbers are p-integral [3, Thm. 1.7]. The operator P is self adjoint, since each coefficient $Q_j(\theta)$ of x^j satisfies $Q_j(-\theta - j) = Q_j(\theta)$.

Lemma 5.1 (Integral change of lift in rank four)**.** *Let $p \geq 5$. Suppose $z_0, \ldots, z_3$ solve a monic fourth order equation in $\mathbb{Z}_p[[q]][\theta_q]$. Let $s_0(q)$ and $s_1(q) = cq^p$ be Frobenius lifts with $c \in 1 + p\mathbb{Z}_p$ and $s_0/s_1 \in 1 + p\mathbb{Z}_p[[q]]$. There is $T \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[q]][\theta_q]$ such that $T(z_i(s_1)) = z_i(s_0)$ for every i.*

Proof. Write $h = \log(s_0/s_1) \in p\mathbb{Z}_p[[q]]$. Reduce each power θ_z^k modulo the monic source equation as $\sum_{i=0}^{3} r_{ki}(z)\theta_z^i$, with $r_{ki} \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[z]]$. For $k < 4$ this is just $r_{ki} = \delta_{ki}$. Taylor's formula gives, on solutions,

$$z_i(s_0) = \sum_{k\geq 0} \frac{h^k}{k!}(\theta_z^k z_i)(s_1) = \sum_{j=0}^{3} b_j(q)(\theta_z^j z_i)(s_1), \qquad b_j = \sum_{k\geq 0} \frac{h^k}{k!} r_{kj}(s_1).$$

These sums converge p-adically. For $k \geq 4$ and $p \geq 5$, $k - v_p(k!) \geq 3$, while the $k < 4$ terms give $b_j \in p^j\mathbb{Z}_p[[q]]$ directly. Consequently every b_j belongs to $p^j\mathbb{Z}_p[[q]]$. Since $(\theta_z^j z_i)(s_1) = p^{-j}\theta_q^j(z_i(s_1))$, take $T = \sum_j p^{-j} b_j \theta_q^j$. This proof explains why an unreduced Taylor series with integral coefficients cannot simply be asserted, and why $p = 3$ needs a separate argument. □

Theorem 5.2. *Let $p \geq 5$. Suppose P has a p-adic Frobenius structure for the lift $x \mapsto x^p$ with $\alpha_1 = \frac{1}{p}\log_p c_p$. Then $K \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[q]]$ and (2) holds for all n divisible by p. The twisted numbers n_d are p-integral for every d.*

Proof. Theorem 1.4 and Lemma 2.3 of [3] give $q \in x + x^2\mathbb{Z}_p[[x]]$ and $y_0 \in 1 + x\mathbb{Z}_p[[x]]$. Dividing solutions by y_0 and changing to q therefore preserves integrality of the monic equation and of the Frobenius operator. Let $z_i = y_i/y_0$, $\Lambda = \log q$, and $\ell = p\alpha_1 = \log_p c_p$. The original lift becomes $s_0(q) = q(x(q)^p)$, with $s_0/q^p \in 1 + p\mathbb{Z}_p[[q]]$. Lemma 5.1 transports its operator to the lift $s_1(q) = c_p q^p$, preserving the action

$$A(z_i(s_1)) = p^i \sum_{j\leq i} \alpha_j z_{i-j}.$$

The transported operator has integral coefficients; composition followed by reduction modulo the pulled-back monic equation keeps them integral.

Put $a = \ell/(p-1) \in p\mathbb{Z}_p$, $M = \Lambda + a$, and $\widetilde{z}_i = \sum_{j=0}^{i} a^{i-j} z_j/(i-j)!$. Their first four expressions are

$$1, \quad M, \quad \tfrac{1}{2}M^2 + V_2, \quad \tfrac{1}{6}M^3 + MV_2 + V_3.$$

Since $M(s_1) = pM$, the action on this basis has constants $\beta_i = [u^i](\sum_j \alpha_j u^j)e^{-\alpha_1 u}$. In particular $\beta_1 = 0$, $\beta_2 = \alpha_2 - \alpha_1^2/2$ and $\beta_3 = \alpha_3 - \alpha_1\alpha_2 + \alpha_1^3/3$, all in $\mathbb{Z}_p$. From $A(1) = 1$ and $A(M) = M$ we obtain $A = 1 + B\theta_q^2$ with $B \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[q]][\theta_q]$.

In the following, a superscript σ means composition with s_1. Applying A to $\widetilde{z}_2^{\sigma}$ gives

$$p^{-2}V_2^{\sigma} - V_2 = \beta_2 - BK^{\sigma}, \qquad K = 1 + \theta_q^2 V_2. \tag{3}$$

Taking two derivatives yields $(1 + \theta_q^2 \circ B)K^{\sigma} = K$. The contraction argument of [3, Lemma 2.3] also applies to $s_1 = c_p q^p$, since it increases q-adic order by p. Hence $K \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[q]]$.

Self-duality gives $2V_2 + \theta_q V_3 = 0$. It follows that $\theta_q^2 \widetilde{z}_3^{\sigma} = p^3 M K^{\sigma}$. Apply A to $\widetilde{z}_3^{\sigma}$ and subtract M times (3); this gives

$$\psi := p^{-3}V_3^{\sigma} - V_3 = \beta_3 - [B, M]K^{\sigma} \in \mathbb{Z}_p[[q]].$$

Here $[B, M]$ is integral: if $B = \sum b_j \theta_q^j$ then $[B, M] = \sum j b_j \theta_q^{j-1}$. Taking three derivatives and using self-duality once more gives

$$K(c_p q^p) - K(q) = -\tfrac{1}{2}\theta_q^3 \psi.$$

At degree n divisible by p, its left side is $c_p^{n/p} K_{n/p} - K_n$, and its right side belongs to $n^3\mathbb{Z}_p$. This proves (2); the last assertion follows from the next lemma. □

Lemma 5.3 (Twisted multicover integrality)**.** *Fix an odd prime p and suppose $K_m \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ for every m. For the weights of Section 4, the congruences* (2) *for all $p \mid m$ are equivalent to $n_d \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ for every d.*

Proof. For every $d, k \geq 1$ one has

$$w_d(pk) = c_p^{dk} w_d(k). \tag{4}$$

For odd k use multiplicativity of the Jacobi symbol and $dk \equiv d \pmod 2$. For even k and odd d both sides vanish; for even k and even d the sign is 1 and the equality follows by subtracting the exponents of 2. Also $w_d(1) = 1$ and all weights are integers.

Write $m = p^r u$ with $p \nmid u$ and $r \geq 1$. Subtract $c_p^{m/p} K_{m/p}$ from K_m. Equation (4) cancels precisely the terms with $d \mid m/p$, leaving

$$K_m - c_p^{m/p} K_{m/p} = \sum_{\substack{d \mid m \\ v_p(d) = r}} n_d d^3 w_d(m/d).$$

If all n_d are p-integral, this belongs to $p^{3r}\mathbb{Z}_p$. Conversely, induct on m. When $p \nmid m$, the defining recursion and $K_m \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ prove integrality of n_m because m^3 is a unit. When $p \mid m$, all terms in the last sum with $d < m$ lie in $p^{3r}\mathbb{Z}_p$ by induction. The congruence then puts its remaining term $m^3 n_m$ in $p^{3r}\mathbb{Z}_p$, so $n_m \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ as well. □

Remark 5.4. Theorem 5.2 proves no assertion at $p = 2, 3$. In particular, a proof of Hypothesis 5.7 would establish integrality away from $2, 3$, not integer-valuedness without further work at these two primes.

The value of α_1 in the theorem is the one the cusp predicts.

Proposition 5.5. *For every odd prime p, $c_p \equiv 1 \pmod p$ and $c_p^4 = (-4)^{p-1}$. Consequently the lift of the x-line that corresponds to $q_\tau \mapsto q_\tau^p$ under* (1) *has the form $x \mapsto c_p\, x^p(1 + O(x))$.*

Proof. By Euler's criterion $2^{(p-1)/2} \equiv \left(\frac{2}{p}\right) \pmod p$, so $c_p \equiv 1$. Also $c_p^4 = 2^{2(p-1)} = 4^{p-1} = (-4)^{p-1}$. If $x^\sigma = c\, x^p(1 + O(x))$ and $q_\tau(x^\sigma) = q_\tau(x)^p$, comparing leading terms in (1) gives $-4c^4 = (-4)^p$, so $c^4 = (-4)^{p-1}$, and $c \equiv 1$ singles out $c = c_p$ among the fourth roots. □

This explains where the value of α_1 comes from. Heuristically, D inherits a Frobenius structure from Dwork's theory of the Gauss equation, pulled back along $z(x)$ (the gauge factor $(1-16x)^{-1/4}$ contributes a unit of $1 + p\mathbb{Z}_p[[x]]$), and the canonical lift of the Tate curve $q_\tau \mapsto q_\tau^p$ then gives $\alpha_1 = \frac{1}{p}\log_p c_p$. We have not made this chain rigorous. Integrality does not determine α_1 for L (Observation 6.6), so the value cannot be read off from L alone, and the natural hypothesis concerns P directly.

Proposition 5.6 (An obstruction at the prime 3)**.** *The operator P has no BV-strong Frobenius structure for the lift $x \mapsto x^3$ with coefficients in $\mathbb{Z}_3[[x]]$ and $A_0(0) = 1$.*

Proof. Write $A = \sum_{i=0}^{3} \sum_{N \geq 0} A_{i,N} x^N \theta^i$, and let $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3$ be its Frobenius constants. Comparing the coefficient of x^0 in the Frobenius identity gives $A_{i,0} = \alpha_i$, so all three constants must lie in $\mathbb{Z}_3$. The coefficient recurrence for that identity, computed directly from P, gives

$$A_{3,3} = -\frac{114512}{9} + \frac{766216}{9}\alpha_1 + 90440\alpha_2 + 25456\alpha_3,$$

and

$$A_{2,9} = \frac{64339413849976508288}{55125} - \frac{539829813570751232}{1575}\alpha_1 \\ - 241119247830016\alpha_2 - 1373373545472\alpha_3.$$

Their integrality would imply, respectively,

$$0 \equiv 9A_{3,3} \equiv 4 + \alpha_1 \pmod 9, \qquad 0 \equiv 9A_{2,9} \equiv 7 + 7\alpha_1 \pmod 9.$$

Thus $\alpha_1 \equiv 5 \pmod 9$ and $\alpha_1 \equiv 8 \pmod 9$, a contradiction. These are exact rational coefficient identities; the standalone calculation `prime3_obstruction.py` verifies them without the Hadamard model or the affine-lattice solver. □

This obstruction concerns the specified strong Frobenius structure and lift. It does not contradict the twisted Yukawa congruences at 3, which hold in the tested range, and does not rule out a different argument for them.

Hypothesis 5.7. For every prime $p \geq 5$, P has a p-adic Frobenius structure in the sense of [3, Def. 1.1] for the lift $x \mapsto x^p$, with $\alpha_1 = \frac{1}{p}\log_p c_p$.

Corollary 5.8. *Under Hypothesis 5.7, the congruences* (2) *hold for every prime $p \geq 5$ and all n.*

The hypothesis can be tested directly. Write the Frobenius basis as $Y(x,\varepsilon) = \sum_n A_n(\varepsilon)x^{n+\varepsilon}$ and $A = \sum_i A_i(x)\theta^i$ with $A_i = \sum_r A_{i,r}x^r$. By [3, Remark 1.2] the defining property is $A(Y(x^p,\varepsilon)) = \alpha(p\varepsilon)\,Y(x,p\varepsilon)$ modulo ε^4, with $\alpha(\varepsilon) = \sum_j \alpha_j\varepsilon^j$ and $\alpha_0 = 1$. Comparing coefficients of $x^{N+p\varepsilon}$ gives

$$\sum_{\substack{0\leq r\leq N\\ r\equiv N\ (p)}} \sum_{i=0}^{3} A_{i,r}\,(N-r+p\varepsilon)^i\,A_{(N-r)/p}(\varepsilon) = \alpha(p\varepsilon)\,A_N(p\varepsilon) \pmod{\varepsilon^4}.$$

The term $r = N$ is $\sum_i A_{i,N}(p\varepsilon)^i$, so the system is triangular: each $A_{i,N}$ is an affine function of $\alpha_1,\alpha_2,\alpha_3$ with rational coefficients. The strong integrality $A_{i,N} \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ then becomes a condition on the α_j.

Observation 5.9. For P there exist $\alpha_1,\alpha_2,\alpha_3 \in \mathbb{Z}_p$ for which every $A_{i,N}$ with $N \leq R$ lies in $\mathbb{Z}_p$, and every such choice has the predicted first constant:

p	R	α_1 forced to	$\frac{1}{p}\log_p c_p$
5	30	509 mod 5^4	509 mod 5^4
7	40	22 mod 7^2	22 mod 7^2
11	60	8 mod 11^2	8 mod 11^2
13	70	86 mod 13^2	86 mod 13^2
17	80	270 mod 17^2	270 mod 17^2
5	500	13634 mod 5^6	13634 mod 5^6
7	500	47748 mod 7^6	47748 mod 7^6
5	650	310509 mod 5^8	310509 mod 5^8
5	1000	310509 mod 5^8	310509 mod 5^8
7	700	47748 mod 7^6	47748 mod 7^6
11	500	4848 mod 11^4	4848 mod 11^4
13	500	4142 mod 13^4	4142 mod 13^4

The same computation for $I \star L'$ with L' the Apéry, Almkvist-Zudilin and Domb operators forces $\alpha_1 \equiv 0$ (modulo 5^2, and modulo 7^2 for the first two), as the untwisted theory predicts. For L itself the condition leaves α_1 free in this range (Observation 6.6).

The rows are certified by an exact affine-lattice computation, rather than by stopping a digit search at a specified precision. For each row condition $c + v\alpha \in \mathbb{Z}_p$, intersect the current lattice

$\alpha = b + B\mathbb{Z}_p^3$ with that condition by solving one linear congruence. Direct substitution verifies that the resulting base and every basis column satisfy every coefficient condition. In all rows above the entire solution set is $\alpha_1 = r + p^s\mathbb{Z}_p$, $\alpha_2, \alpha_3 \in \mathbb{Z}_p$, with r, s as tabulated. Thus the exact predicted p-adic value of α_1 is admissible in every truncation checked.

There is a precise passage from finite to infinite structures, but it requires truncations of every degree, not just arbitrarily many digits at one degree.

Proposition 5.10. *Fix $p \geq 5$ and $\alpha_1 = \log_p(c_p)/p$. Let $C_R \subset \mathbb{Z}_p^2$ be the set of (α_2, α_3) for which every $A_{i,N}$ with $N \leq R$ is integral. A Frobenius structure with the specified α_1 exists if and only if $C_R \neq \varnothing$ for every R.*

Proof. Each C_R is closed: the coefficients $A_{i,N}$ are continuous affine $\mathbb{Q}_p$-valued functions of the constants, and $\mathbb{Z}_p$ is closed in $\mathbb{Q}_p$. The sets are nested in the compact space $\mathbb{Z}_p^2$. If all are nonempty, compactness gives a point in their intersection. The triangular recursion then produces all integral coefficients $A_{i,N}$; the coefficient identity in the preceding display proves the Frobenius action on all four solutions. The converse is immediate. □

The missing assertion is therefore nonemptiness of C_R for every R. Section 6 records the approaches tried and where each stops.

6. Approaches to the hypothesis

This section records models of the period of P and the routes to Hypothesis 5.7 they suggest. Two of the routes are closed by proof or by computation: product Laurent models (Proposition 6.4) and a general transfer through the Hadamard product (Observation 6.6).

6.1. **A modular-base model.** The modular base suggests a linear Laurent model: with $g = a + b + w + 1/(abw^3)$, $\mathrm{CT}\,(1 - sg)^{-1} = {}_3F_2(\frac{1}{6}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{5}{6}; 1, 1; 1728s^6)$, and Clausen's identity gives $\sum u_n x^n = (1 - 16x)^{-1/2}\,{}_3F_2(\frac{1}{6}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{5}{6}; 1, 1; -6912x^4/(1 - 16x)^3)$. This relates a $1 - sg$ model to L only on an algebraic cover, and its simplex has a face of determinant 3, so it meets neither the unimodular-face hypothesis of [3, Thm. 3.3] nor the symmetry hypothesis of [4, Prop. 7.7]. More fundamentally, the Hadamard product does not commute with a change of base: for $H = \sum h_n x^n$, $I \star H(x^4) = \sum h_n \binom{8n}{4n} x^{4n}$ while $(I \star H)(x^4) = \sum h_n \binom{2n}{n} x^{4n}$. The model of Proposition 2.5 is not of the form $1 - tg$ used in [3, 4] because of its t^2 term; Section 6.4 removes that term.

6.2. **An elliptic fibration for the double-cover model.** The compressed period also gives an explicit compactification candidate for P, without moving its base variable. Use homogeneous coordinates $[A : B : C]$ on $\mathbb{P}^2$ and $[Z_0 : Z_1]$ on $\mathbb{P}^1$. Define

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{B}_t = ABC\big[&ABCZ_0^2Z_1^2 - 16tABZ_0Z_1(Z_0 + Z_1)^2(A + B + C)\\ &+ t^2C^3(Z_0 + Z_1)^4\big].\end{aligned}$$

This section has bidegree $(6, 4)$. The double cover $V^2 = \mathcal{B}_t$ therefore has trivial dualising sheaf by the double-cover canonical-bundle formula, since $K_{\mathbb{P}^2 \times \mathbb{P}^1} = \mathcal{O}(-3, -2)$. This does not assert smoothness or the existence of a crepant resolution. On the affine chart $C = Z_1 = 1$, put $a = A$, $b = B$, $z = Z_0$. The equality

$$V^2 = a^2b^2z^2\left(1 - 16th(z)(1 + a + b) + \frac{t^2h(z)^2}{ab}\right)$$

shows that the period of $da \wedge db \wedge dz/V$ on the torus cycle is exactly the constant term in Corollary 2.6, hence $y_0(P)$. The cycle is understood for small complex t and then expanded formally.

For the corresponding K3 model of L, clearing denominators gives

$$v^2 = ab\big[ab(1-16t(1+a+b))+t^2\big].$$

Viewed as a cubic in a, this is an elliptic fibration with a rational two-torsion point. Set $\alpha=-16tb^2$, $X=\alpha a$, $Y=\alpha v$. Its Weierstrass equation is

$$Y^2 = X^3 + b^2(1-16t(b+1))X^2 - 16t^3b^3X. \tag{5}$$

Writing $a_2 = b^2(1-16t(b+1))$, $a_4=-16t^3b^3$, one obtains

$$\Delta = 16a_4^2(a_2^2-4a_4) = 4096t^6b^9\big[b(1-16t(b+1))^2+64t^3\big].$$

For generic t, the minimal elliptic surface has a III^* fibre at $b=0$, an I_6^* fibre at $b=\infty$, and three I_1 fibres. The local orders of (c_4,c_6,Δ) are $(3,5,9)$ and $(2,3,12)$ at the first two points; the Euler numbers sum to 24. This gives a K3 surface with a rank-19 trivial lattice. The cubic factor has discriminant

$$-2^{20}t^6(4t-1)^2(432t^2-40t+1).$$

For P, the affine elliptic fibration is instead

$$Y^2 = X^3 + b^2\big[z^2-16tz(z+1)^2(b+1)\big]X^2 - 16t^3b^3z(z+1)^6X.$$

This is a concrete starting point for a different fibration argument. A proof of Hypothesis 5.7 through this model still requires a suitable resolution over $\mathbb{Z}_p$, a semistable model at $t=0$, and identification of the rank-four integral cohomology lattice. The period identity alone proves none of these assertions.

6.3. **No completely symmetric $\sqrt{2}$ certificate.** There is an obstruction to the originally proposed completely symmetric Laurent certificate with common vertex coefficient $\sqrt{2}$. If $g = 16+\gamma\sum_{v\in S}X^v$ with $S\subset\mathbb{Z}^r\setminus\{0\}$ and $\mathrm{CT}(g^n)=y_0(P)_n$, then its centred second and third moments give

$$320=\gamma^2N_2, \qquad 6144=\gamma^3N_3,$$

where N_j counts ordered j-tuples in S with sum zero. Both counts are positive integers, so $\gamma=(6144/320)(N_2/N_3)\in\mathbb{Q}$. Constant terms are invariant under monomial rescaling. Hence a model made completely symmetric with common irrational vertex coefficient by such a rescaling cannot represent P. This rules out that particular direct use of [4, Prop. 7.7]; it does not rule out Laurent models with differing vertex coefficients or additional nonvertex terms.

6.4. **A linear Laurent model and its Hasse-Witt obstruction.** The quadratic dependence on the base parameter in the preceding models can be removed. This yields a reflexive Laurent model for the period of P itself, although its full Hasse-Witt matrices do not satisfy the condition used in the cited Dwork-crystal construction.

Proposition 6.1. *Write $h(s)=s+2+s^{-1}$ and put*

$$G(u,v,y,z) = h(z)\left[4(1+uv+u/v)h(y)+\frac{y^{-1}-y}{2u}\right].$$

Then $G\in\mathbb{Z}[1/2][u^{\pm1},v^{\pm1},y^{\pm1},z^{\pm1}]$ and

$$y_0(t) = \mathrm{CT}_{u,v,y,z}\,\frac{1}{1-tG}.$$

Its Newton polytope is

$$\Delta = \mathrm{conv}\{(-1,0),(1,-1),(1,1)\}\times[-1,1]^2.$$

This is a four-dimensional reflexive polytope, with 12 vertices, 45 lattice points and the origin as its unique interior lattice point.

Proof. For commuting Laurent polynomials A, B, C independent of y, formal expansion at $t = 0$ gives

$$\mathrm{CT}_y \frac{1}{1 - t(C + Ay + B/y)} = \big((1 - tC)^2 - 4t^2AB\big)^{-1/2}.$$

Indeed, after factoring $1 - tC$, only even powers $2r$ of $Ay + B/y$ contribute, with constant term $\binom{2r}{r}(AB)^r$. Set $S = 1 + uv + u/v$ and take

$$C = 8Sh(z), \qquad A = h(z)\left(4S - \frac{1}{2u}\right), \qquad B = h(z)\left(4S + \frac{1}{2u}\right).$$

Then $C + Ay + B/y = G$, and its discriminant is

$$(1 - tC)^2 - 4t^2AB = 1 - 16th(z)S + \frac{t^2h(z)^2}{u^2}.$$

Under $a = uv$, $b = u/v$, a monomial a^ib^j becomes $u^{i+j}v^{i-j}$. The exponent map is injective, so this substitution preserves constant terms even though its determinant has absolute value 2. The period identity now follows from the double-cover representation

$$y_0(t) = \mathrm{CT}_{a,b,z}\left(1 - 16th(z)(1 + a + b) + \frac{t^2h(z)^2}{ab}\right)^{-1/2}.$$

All support points of G lie in the displayed product polytope, and all of its 12 vertices occur with nonzero coefficients. Thus this is exactly its Newton polytope. In the coordinate order (u, v, y, z), its seven facets have primitive integral outward normals

$$(1, 0, 0, 0), \quad (-1, 2, 0, 0), \quad (-1, -2, 0, 0), \quad (0, 0, \pm 1, 0), \quad (0, 0, 0, \pm 1),$$

and each facet has equation $\ell = 1$. This proves reflexivity. The triangle has five lattice points and the interval has three, giving $5 \cdot 3 \cdot 3 = 45$ lattice points. The triangle and each interval have only the origin in their respective lattice interiors. □

Proposition 6.2. *For every odd prime p, the full-polytope first Hasse-Witt determinant of $1-tG$ in the sense of* [3, Definition 3.2] *is not a unit in $\mathbb{Z}_p[[t]]$.*

Proof. Consider the edge

$$E = \{(1, 1, s, 1) : -1 \le s \le 1\} \subset \Delta.$$

The sum of monomials of G supported on E is $4uvzh(y)$. The only lattice point in the pyramid over the relative interior of E, with the apex removed, is $w = (1, 1, 0, 1)$: its first coordinate forces the radial scaling factor to be 1. By the face-block factorisation of [3, Proposition 3.5 and Lemma 3.6], the first Hasse-Witt matrix at $t = 0$ has a one-by-one diagonal block whose entry is the coefficient of $u^{p-1}v^{p-1}z^{p-1}y^0$ in $(1 - 4uvzh(y))^{p-1}$. This entry is

$$4^{p-1}\,\mathrm{CT}_y\, h(y)^{p-1} = 4^{p-1}\binom{2p-2}{p-1}.$$

For $p \ge 3$, the factorial $(2p - 2)!$ has exactly one factor of p and $(p - 1)!$ has none. The entry therefore has valuation exactly 1. All the other diagonal blocks have integral entries. The full determinant is divisible by p at $t = 0$ and is consequently not a unit. □

This is an obstruction to applying the stated theorem to the entire crystal of this particular Laurent model. It is not an obstruction to a Frobenius structure on the rank-four differential equation. A construction through a suitable smaller quotient, resolution or different Laurent presentation would need additional justification.

Remark 6.3. There is an even more immediate, but less symmetric, linear model

$$G_0(a,b,y,z) = h(z)\left[8(1+a+b) + y + \frac{16(1+a+b)^2 - 1/(4ab)}{y}\right].$$

The same constant-term identity shows that $\mathrm{CT}(1-tG_0)^{-1} = y_0(t)$. Thus existence of a denominator linear in t is not itself the remaining difficulty. The missing part is an integral Frobenius construction on the required rank-four quotient with the correct normalisation.

The obstruction in Proposition 6.2 does not depend on the chosen model for the factor $\binom{2n}{n}$. Any model that realises the Hadamard product $P = I \star L$ as a product of Laurent polynomials in separate variables fails in the same way.

Proposition 6.4. *Let $f(z)$ and $g(x)$ be Laurent polynomials with p-integral coefficients in disjoint sets of variables, with reflexive Newton polytopes Δ_f and Δ_g, and suppose $\mathrm{CT}(f^n) = \binom{2n}{n}$ for all n. Then for every odd prime p the first Hasse-Witt condition of* [3, Definition 3.2] *fails for $1 - tf(z)g(x)$.*

Proof. The Newton polytope of fg is $\Delta = \Delta_f \times \Delta_g$, which is reflexive, so $L(1) = 0$ and the condition asks for $\det HW^{(1)}$ to be a unit. Let v be a vertex of Δ_g, with coefficient c in g, and let $\tau = \Delta_f \times \{v\}$. In a reflexive polytope every nonzero lattice point has degree 1, so the lattice points of the pyramid over τ° with 0 removed are the lattice points of τ°. Since 0 is the only interior lattice point of Δ_f, this set is $\{(0,v)\}$. The monomials of fg supported on τ sum to $c\,x^v f(z)$. By [3, Lemma 3.6] with $k=1$, the corresponding one-by-one block of $HW^{(1)}|_{t=0}$ is the coefficient of $x^{(p-1)v}z^0$ in $(1 - c\,x^v f(z))^{p-1}$, which is

$$c^{p-1}\,\mathrm{CT}\big(f^{p-1}\big) = c^{p-1}\binom{2p-2}{p-1} \equiv 0 \pmod p.$$

By [3, Proposition 3.5] the determinant at $t=0$ is divisible by p. □

A product polytope is reflexive only when both factors are, and [3, Proposition 1.8] requires reflexivity. Hence no choice of model for $\binom{2n}{n}$, in any number of variables, makes [3, Proposition 1.8] applicable to a product model of P. The failure sits in the factor $\binom{2n}{n}$ itself, whose truncation at $n = p-1$ vanishes modulo p, and not in the edges of any particular polytope. An exhaustive search over Laurent polynomials supported on $[-1,1]^2$ with coefficients in $\{0, \pm 1, \pm 2\}$ and the origin interior found 996 models with $\mathrm{CT}(f^n) = \binom{2n}{n}$ for $n \le 8$. None of them has vertex coefficients $\pm 2^a$ together with length-two edges of discriminant $\pm 2^a$ (`hw2/good_faces.py`). A Laurent model to which the cited theorem applies must therefore mix the variables of the two Hadamard factors.

6.5. **A finite sum for the logarithmic periods.** Let $(u)_m$ denote a rising factorial. For $N \ge 0$ define

$$C_N(\varepsilon) = \sum_{m=0}^{\lfloor N/4 \rfloor} \frac{(-1)^m 16^{N-2m}(\frac{1}{2}+\frac{3}{4}\varepsilon)_{N-m}}{(1+\frac{1}{4}\varepsilon)_m^3 (N-4m)!}, \qquad B_N(\varepsilon) = \frac{4^N(\frac{1}{2}+\varepsilon)_N}{(1+\varepsilon)_N}.$$

Proposition 6.5. *If $A_N(\varepsilon)$ is the Frobenius coefficient of P normalised by $A_0(\varepsilon) = 1$, then*

$$A_N(\varepsilon) = B_N(\varepsilon) C_N(\varepsilon) \pmod{\varepsilon^3}.$$

All four logarithmic jets are given by

$$A_N(\varepsilon) = B_N(\varepsilon)\big(C_N(\varepsilon) + \varepsilon^3 U_N\big) \pmod{\varepsilon^4},$$

where $U = \sum U_N x^N$ is uniquely specified by $U_0 = 0$ and

$$L(U) = 1 - (1 - 4x)(1 - 16x)^{-1/2}.$$

Proof. Deform the hypergeometric Frobenius series by replacing each upper parameter by its value plus $\varepsilon/4$, and each lower rising factorial by $(1+\varepsilon/4)_m$. After the pullback, its normalisation is

$$x^\varepsilon (1-16x)^{-1/2-3\varepsilon/4} \sum_{m\geq 0} \frac{(\frac{1}{6}+\varepsilon/4)_m (\frac{1}{2}+\varepsilon/4)_m (\frac{5}{6}+\varepsilon/4)_m}{(1+\varepsilon/4)_m^3} \left(\frac{-6912x^4}{(1-16x)^3}\right)^m.$$

Triplication replaces the three numerator factors by $3^{-3m}(\frac{1}{2}+3\varepsilon/4)_{3m}$; the binomial expansion of the prefactor then gives C_N. For a general function $F(z)$ the exact operator identity is

$$L\big((1-16x)^{-1/2} F(z(x))\big) = 64(1-4x)(1-16x)^{-1/2} (H_z F)(z(x)),$$

where $H_z = \theta_z^3 - z(\theta_z + 1/6)(\theta_z + 1/2)(\theta_z + 5/6)$. The deformed series has residual $(\varepsilon/4)^3 z^{\varepsilon/4}$ under H_z. Thus its residual under L is $\varepsilon^3 x^\varepsilon (1-4x)(1-16x)^{-1/2}$ modulo ε^4. The required normalised recurrence has residual $\varepsilon^3 x^\varepsilon$. Adding $\varepsilon^3 x^\varepsilon U(x)$ supplies their difference. Finally, the Hadamard recurrence multiplies each coefficient by B_N, as is seen from $B_N/B_{N-1} = 2(2N - 1 + 2\varepsilon)/(N + \varepsilon)$. □

This formula includes the logarithmic periods, whereas the original multinomial sum gave only the holomorphic period. It provides an arithmetic route to the Frobenius hypothesis, but an all-degree p-adic divisibility argument for these sums and their inhomogeneous correction is still needed.

6.6. **No general transfer through the Hadamard product.** A natural plan is to build the structure on D from Dwork's theory of the Gauss equation, pass it to $L = \mathrm{Sym}^2 D$, and then transfer it across the Hadamard product with I. The last step cannot be a general lemma.

Observation 6.6. For the lift $x \mapsto x^p$ with $p = 5, 7$ and all coefficients of degree at most 60, the operator L of this paper and the Apéry operator each admit integral truncated Frobenius structures for every residue of α_1 modulo p^2. For P the integrality of A_0 and A_1 alone already forces $\alpha_1 \equiv \frac{1}{p}\log_p c_p \pmod{p^2}$, at both primes. For $I \star$Apéry the same two coefficients force $\alpha_1 \equiv 0 \pmod{25}$ at $p = 5$; at $p = 7$ they leave five residues, all divisible by 7, and A_2 removes all but 0.

Within the tested range, integrality on L does not constrain the first constant, while integrality on $I \star L$ fixes it. A lemma of the form "an integral structure on L with first constant x yields one on $I \star L$ with first constant x" could therefore hold for at most one residue class of x, and a proof must use more than the integrality of the structure on L. The factor $\binom{2n}{n}$ selects the first constant, and the selection is already visible at the level of the mirror map. A proof along these lines would have to show that the structure induced from the cusp of D is the one selected, which is Hypothesis 5.7 in another form.

7. Discussion

The expectation recorded in [7, 2] is that integrality of the period and the mirror map implies integrality of the instanton numbers. Bogner's operator suggests a corrected form: the instanton numbers are integral in the Frobenius compatible coordinate, and that coordinate may only be defined over a number field. Here it is $\sqrt{2}\,q$, and the multicover formula has to be made Galois equivariant. Heuristically, in Hodge theoretic terms, the limiting extension class at the maximal unipotent point is $\frac{1}{4}[-4] = \frac{1}{2}[2]$ modulo torsion in $\mathbb{Q}^\times \otimes \mathbb{Q}$, which lies outside the image of $\mathbb{Q}^\times \otimes \mathbb{Z}$. This heuristic does not prove that every rational rescaling fails: Proposition 3.2 is only

a bounded search, and Proposition 3.1 has an all-prime assumption. The exclusion of arbitrary rational scalings remains open here.

The general idea of number-field-valued 3-functions in examples studied by Bogner and van Straten was already mentioned by Schwarz, Vologodsky and Walcher [6, footnote 9]. That remark does not identify this operator or supply a proof of the particular congruences here; it does mean that novelty of the general quadratic-field interpretation should not be claimed.

Two questions remain. The first is a proof of Hypothesis 5.7. By Section 6, a Laurent certificate must mix the variables of the two Hadamard factors, and an argument through L must explain why the Hadamard product selects the value of α_1 that the cusp predicts. The double cover of Section 6 is the most direct geometric candidate, but it still needs a resolution over $\mathbb{Z}_p$ and an identification of its integral rank-four lattice. A search for a two variable model of D on reflexive polygons, with constant term forced into $12\mathbb{Z}$ by parity, found none with coefficients of absolute value at most 4. The gauge factor $(432x^2 - 40x + 1)^{1/4}$ in the remark of Section 2 suggests why: f itself is probably not a constant term series. The second question is whether other operators in the tables of [1] whose instanton numbers look defective become integral after a twist of this kind.

8. Verification

Every statement marked as checked or observed was produced in exact arithmetic by the scripts in the accompanying repository [9]. They cover the decomposition and the pullback identity, the closed form and the constant-term models, the rescaling search (which recovers a planted scaling), the twisted formula and the congruences (2) together with their mutants (wrong field, missing sign, wrong character, corrupted coefficient), the controls of Table 2, the exact affine-lattice certificates of Observation 5.9, the obstruction at $p = 3$, the Laurent models and the Hasse-Witt search, the transfer test of Observation 6.6, the logarithmic jets, and the elliptic fibrations and moments of Section 6.

The elementary algebra is formally verified in Lean 4 with Mathlib [8]: the recurrence of $P = I \star L$ from that of L, the facts $c_p \equiv 1 \pmod p$ and $c_p^4 = 4^{p-1}$, the weight identity (4), the divisibility $p \mid \binom{2p-2}{p-1}$ behind the Hasse-Witt obstructions, and the arithmetic modulo 9 at the prime 3. The p-adic Frobenius theory of Beukers and Vlasenko, and with it Theorem 5.2, Lemma 5.1 and Proposition 5.10, are not formalised; the symbolic identities (the symmetric square and the pullback) are checked in a computer algebra system.

Acknowledgments

The structure of the operator, the twisted formula, the conditional theorem, the certificates and the Lean formalisation were developed with AI assistance (Claude, Anthropic; OpenAI Codex), and every computation was checked by the scripts above. The author is responsible for the content.

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